

a balance of both. In case it's the latter, just over-provision your SSD by 15% and use the rest of the space.

63 Get a shielded cable

If you happen to hear a weird static noise coming from your speakers then you might have a problem of electromagnetic interference creeping into your speaker cables. This becomes worse when you have a smartphone lying around the speakers and an incoming message or call causes a strange buzzing to erupt in your speakers. This happens because your average budget 2.1 speakers don't come with shielded cables. The solution? Hop over to your nearest audio store or ecommerce store and look for a replacement cable that has shielding. Last we checked, Amazon Basics has some really good shielded audio cables.

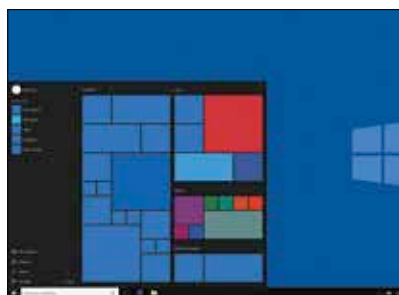
64 Know your temps

All components within your computer have an optimal operating temperature range. The usual rule of the thumb is that the cooler your components are, the longer they will last. Processors and graphics cards have built in temperature control mechanisms that will reduce the performance of the processor or the graphics card to bring temperatures down should they get too high. If you are experiencing any sluggishness with your PC, then one of the reasons could be a high internal temperature. So how much is too much? Well, it varies according to the individual component and the generation of that component as well. The current genera-

tion of Intel processors i.e. 9th Gen has a maximum junction temperature of 100 degrees celsius, so if the processor spends too much time at that temperature, then the thermal throttling will kick in. With the recent GTX 1080 Ti, the temperature is about 84 degrees celsius, below which, the card runs without any throttling at all. This varies from manufacturer to manufacturer since board partners can set the threshold to different temperatures.

65 Remove Windows 10 bloatware

Windows comes pre-installed with a lot of bloatware that you might never use in your life. Although they might not be meddling with your performance or taking way too much space, removing them is simply a decluttering exercise. This will make your Start menu appear less crowded and contain only the applications that you chose to install in your system. Some Windows applications like Calendar and Mail, Film and TV, Groove Music, etc., aren't really necessary since you're probably using better alternatives. Not all of the applications can be manually installed and for them, you'll



need to use the Windows PowerShell with admin privileges. Right-click on the Start button and click on Windows PowerShell (Admin). Enter the following command: `"Get-AppxPackage *application name*" | Remove-AppxPackage"` without the quotes where the 'application name' is a single-word name of the applications. The application names of some of applications that you can remove are 3D Builder - **3dbuilder**, Alarms and Clock - **windowsalarms**, Calendar and Mail - **windowscommunicationsapps**, Get Office - **officehub**, Groove Music - **zunemusic**, Films and TV - **zunevideo**, News - **bingnews**, People - **people**, Sports - **bingports**, etc. Do

note, you won't be able to uninstall all the applications since they are tied into other system functionalities like Cortana. If you change your mind and want them back, enter the following command in the PowerShell: `"Get-AppxPackage -AllUsers | Foreach {Add-AppxPackage -DisableDevelopmentMode -Register "$($_.InstallLocation)\AppXManifest.xml"}"` without the quotes.

66 Pin websites to taskbar

Your web browser is probably the most used app on your PC and most of the time, it's the same set of websites that you visit everyday. If that's the case, then you can save some time on opening your web browser, typing out your website's domain name and then waiting for it to load. There's another easier method but it's limited to Microsoft Edge only. Open the desired website and click on the hamburger menu of Edge and select 'Pin this page to the taskbar'. The website's icon should now appear on the taskbar. Now, you can open your favourite websites with just the click of a button.

67 Unpark your CPU cores

Some of your CPU cores could probably be parked by default which essentially means that they become inactive while a software or game is running. Hence, it isn't able to use the full potential of your CPU. Parking and unparking changes when you change the power plan settings of your PC. Keeping it on high performance will unpark all the cores and keep them running at all times. In the balanced mode, the parking won't be affected but your CPU's frequency scaling and turbo boost capability is lowered. Power saver completely drops everything and parks the majority of your cores. This also clearly goes on to show that unparking all your cores is going to draw in a lot of power and drain your battery. If you wish to have more granular control over these settings, then download CPU Core Parking Manager 3 from <https://dgit.in/CPUCorePM3>. After installing and running the tool, you will see all the details about your CPU listed where you should look at 'CPU Performance'. You'll see 'Enabled cores' and 'Parked cores'. Based on your Power Plan, there will already be a preset value.

